

free or cheap, whether she needed it or not, and the “food hoarder” with my huge stockpiles. My husband, however, was the avowed “Tightwad,” rinsing out plastic storage bags and saving every disposable pie tin we ever used.

So, who exactly are the “Coupon Queens” of today? Is it even possible to pigeonhole this category of super savers?

We can get a general idea by looking at the specific trends of coupon use described by Nielsen:

- Affluent households tend to be the heaviest coupon users.
- Larger households tend to use more coupons.
- White households are more likely to be heavier coupon users.
- Hispanics and blacks are less likely to use coupons.
- Those with college degrees are more likely to use coupons.

Thanks to a lagging economy and the subsequent increase in coupon use and rapid advances in technology with Internet printed and cellphone coupons, the identity of the “Coupon Queen” is evolving, making it even more difficult to categorize them. For one thing, the “Queen” might actually be a “King.” A May 2010 Harris Interactive poll conducted on behalf of Coupons.com revealed that 51 percent of adult males have used a coupon in the past six months, and over 36 percent of them actually have a designated place to keep their coupons.

Whoever we are—rich or poor, white or black, male or female—and whatever you want to call us—“cherry pickers,” “coupon enthusiasts,”